# TenderPath.me

Procurement Data Source Strategy & Crawler Architecture

*April 2026 | Internal Strategy Document*

## Executive Summary

TenderPath's mission is to surface transparent, actionable procurement opportunities and lower the barrier for SMEs to compete for institutional contracts. UNGM is a necessary starting point but is insufficient as a sole data source. This document maps the full landscape of public procurement portals, proposes a tiered crawling architecture, and outlines the product logic required to ensure every opportunity displayed on TenderPath is one that users can genuinely apply to.

The strategy is built around three principles: transparency (only surface opportunities from open, competitive processes), accessibility (help SMEs navigate registration requirements and eligibility criteria), and comprehensiveness (cover the long tail of opportunities that commercial aggregators and UNGM miss).

## Why UNGM Alone Is Not Enough

UNGM is the UN General Assembly's mandated common procurement portal, and registration there is required for doing business with most UN Secretariat entities. However, relying on it exclusively creates significant blind spots:

- **Incomplete agency coverage.** Many UN agencies (UNDP, WFP, UNICEF) maintain their own procurement portals and post opportunities there first or exclusively. UNGM mirrors some but not all of these.
- **No MDB coverage.** World Bank, AfDB, IsDB, ADB, and other multilateral development bank opportunities are not on UNGM. These represent billions in annual procurement.
- **No national government coverage.** MENA government procurement (Saudi Etimad, Egypt e-Tenders, Bahrain Tender Board) represents the largest volume of opportunities SMEs can realistically win. None of this is on UNGM.
- **No EU-funded procurement.** TED (Tenders Electronic Daily) covers all EU public procurement above threshold values, including EuropeAid contracts in MENA and Africa.
- **Informal solicitations invisible.** RFQs under $40,000 are not required to be formally advertised. These smaller opportunities are often the best entry point for SMEs but exist only on agency-specific portals or are shared via vendor rosters.

# Source Registry

Sources are organized into three tiers based on crawling priority, data quality, and strategic value to TenderPath users.

## Tier 1 — Core Sources (Crawl Daily)

These are the highest-priority sources. They provide structured data, high transparency, and the largest volume of opportunities that SMEs can directly apply to.

| Source | Type | Coverage | Access | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **UNGM** | UN Aggregator | UN System agencies (40+ orgs) | Free registration | Central UN portal. Mandatory for UN Secretariat. Many agencies also post here. |
| **UNDP Procurement** | Agency Direct | UNDP global operations | Open | Highest volume single UN agency. Many country-level RFPs not mirrored on UNGM. |
| **UNPD / UN Secretariat** | Agency Direct | UN Secretariat entities, peacekeeping, political missions | Open | REOIs and formal solicitations. Uses Ariba for e-tendering. |
| **UNOPS** | Agency Direct | Infrastructure, procurement, HR for UN + govts | Open | Major procurement arm. Posts implementation partner and works contracts. |
| **World Bank e-Consultant2** | MDB Portal | WB corporate procurement + consulting | Registration required | Consulting assignments and corporate tenders. Separate from country-executed. |
| **World Bank Projects** | MDB Portal | Country-executed WB-funded projects | Open | Borrower-executed procurement. Links to national procurement portals. |
| **WFP** | Agency Direct | Food, logistics, humanitarian supply chain | Open + UNGM | One of the largest UN procurement budgets (~$4B+/yr). Own e-tendering system. |
| **UNICEF Supply** | Agency Direct | Health supplies, vaccines, education, emergency | Open | Massive procurement volume. Long-term agreements for health/nutrition. |

## Tier 2 — Extended Sources (Crawl Daily/Weekly)

Aggregators and regional development banks that significantly expand coverage. Some require subscriptions for full data access.

| Source | Type | Coverage | Access | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| **dgMarket** | Commercial Aggregator | ~1M notices/yr, 190+ countries, MDBs + govts | Subscription | Largest independent aggregator. Covers MDBs, bilateral agencies, national govts. |
| **Devex** | Commercial Aggregator | Development sector tenders + grants | Subscription | Strong in consulting/technical assistance. Good sector analysis. |
| **TED (EU)** | Regional Portal | EU-funded procurement globally | Free | All EU public procurement above thresholds. Covers EuropeAid external tenders. |
| **African Development Bank** | MDB Portal | AfDB-funded projects across Africa | Open | Critical for MENA-Africa corridor. Own procurement portal. |
| **Islamic Development Bank** | MDB Portal | IsDB member state projects | Open | Key for OIC/MENA region. Sharia-compliant procurement frameworks. |
| **Asian Development Bank** | MDB Portal | ADB-funded projects in Asia-Pacific | Open | Relevant for MENA firms expanding east. |

## Tier 3 — MENA National Portals (Crawl Daily)

National e-procurement portals across the MENA region. These are TenderPath's key differentiation layer — most international aggregators neglect national government procurement, yet this is where SMEs have the highest win probability.

| Source | Type | Coverage | Access | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Egypt e-Procurement** | National Portal | Egyptian government procurement | Registration | Arabic-primary. Covers ministries, governorates, public enterprises. |
| **Bahrain Tender Board** | National Portal | Bahrain government procurement | Open | Well-structured portal. Good data quality. |
| **Saudi Etimad** | National Portal | Saudi government procurement | Registration | Massive volume. Arabic-primary. Covers Vision 2030 projects. |
| **UAE ICP / MOHRE** | National Portal | UAE federal procurement | Registration | Federal level. Emirates also have separate portals. |
| **Jordan JONEPS** | National Portal | Jordanian government procurement | Registration | Electronic procurement system for Jordanian govt. |
| **Iraq e-Gov Procurement** | National Portal | Iraqi government tenders | Varies | Fragmented. Check individual ministry sites too. |

# Crawler Architecture

Each source requires a tailored crawling approach. The architecture should be modular: one adapter per source, unified data model, central deduplication.

## Unified Opportunity Schema

Every crawled opportunity should be normalized into a common schema before display. Required fields:

- Opportunity ID (source-specific, used for dedup)
- Title (original language + English translation if applicable)
- Issuing Organization (standardized name)
- Source Portal (which Tier 1/2/3 source it came from)
- Category (goods, services, works, consulting)
- Sector / CPV codes (Common Procurement Vocabulary, mapped to TenderPath taxonomy)
- Country / Region
- Estimated Value (if disclosed)
- Publication Date
- Submission Deadline
- Eligibility Requirements (registration portals, certifications, geographic restrictions)
- Direct Link to Original Notice
- Documents Available (yes/no, with links if public)
- Status (open, closed, awarded, cancelled)

## Deduplication Logic

Many opportunities appear on multiple portals (e.g., a UNDP tender on both procurement-notices.undp.org and UNGM). The crawler must deduplicate by matching on a combination of issuing organization, reference number, title similarity, and deadline. When duplicates are found, prefer the source with richer metadata and retain all source links for the user.

## Language Handling

MENA national portals are often Arabic-primary. The crawler should store original-language text alongside machine-translated English. Translation quality is critical for search relevance — consider a dedicated translation pipeline rather than relying on generic APIs for procurement-specific terminology.

# Transparency & Applicability Filters

Not every crawled opportunity should be displayed. TenderPath's value proposition depends on only surfacing opportunities that are genuinely transparent and actionable. Apply these filters:

## Display Criteria

- **Open competitive process.** Only display opportunities from open tenders (ITB, RFP, RFQ, EOI). Exclude direct awards, sole-source contracts, and framework agreement call-offs where only pre-registered vendors can participate — unless TenderPath can guide users through the roster registration process.
- **Clear submission pathway.** Every displayed opportunity must link to a portal where the user can actually submit a bid. If the crawler finds an opportunity but cannot determine how to apply, flag it for manual review rather than displaying it.
- **Active deadline.** Only show opportunities with future deadlines. Archive expired ones for market intelligence but remove from active listings.
- **Sufficient information.** Minimum viable listing requires: title, issuing org, deadline, and submission method. Opportunities missing these fields should be flagged, not displayed.

## SME Accessibility Scoring

To genuinely bring new SMEs into the fold, TenderPath should score each opportunity on accessibility. Consider building an "SME Fit Score" based on:

- Estimated contract value (smaller = more accessible to SMEs)
- Registration complexity (UNGM Level 1 vs. Level 2, national portal requirements)
- Experience requirements (years, past contract values, certifications)
- Geographic restrictions (local presence required vs. international competition)
- Language of submission (English-only vs. Arabic-required vs. bilingual accepted)
- Joint venture / consortium allowed (enables SMEs to partner up)

# SME Enablement Strategy

Surfacing opportunities is only half the value. TenderPath can differentiate by actively lowering barriers for first-time bidders:

- **Registration guides.** For each source portal, provide a step-by-step registration walkthrough. UNGM registration alone has two levels with different document requirements — most SMEs give up at this stage.
- **Eligibility pre-screening.** Let users input their company profile (sector, certifications, past contract values, geography) and auto-match against opportunity requirements. Show a clear "you qualify / you don't / you might" signal.
- **Bid calendar and alerts.** Proactive notifications when new opportunities match a user's profile, with enough lead time to prepare a competitive submission.

- **Consortium matching.** For larger contracts that require experience SMEs don’t have, facilitate partnerships between complementary companies on the platform.
- **Award tracking.** Crawl contract award notices to show who won, at what value. This market intelligence helps SMEs understand competitive dynamics and price their bids.

# Implementation Roadmap

## Phase 1: Foundation (Weeks 1–4)

1. Deploy crawlers for UNGM, UNDP, UNPD, and WFP (Tier 1 core UN sources)
2. Implement unified opportunity schema and deduplication engine
3. Build basic search and filtering UI with sector/country/deadline filters
4. Launch with English-language opportunities only

## Phase 2: Expansion (Weeks 5–8)

1. Add remaining Tier 1 sources (World Bank, UNICEF, UNOPS)
2. Add TED (EU) and AfDB/IsDB from Tier 2
3. Implement Arabic language support and translation pipeline
4. Launch SME Fit Score on all listings
5. Build registration guide content for top 5 source portals

## Phase 3: MENA Differentiation (Weeks 9–12)

This is where TenderPath becomes genuinely unique:

- Deploy Tier 3 MENA national portal crawlers (Egypt, Bahrain, Saudi, UAE, Jordan)
- Build eligibility pre-screening engine
- Launch bid calendar and alert system
- Begin crawling contract award notices for market intelligence
- Explore consortium matching as a premium feature

# Success Metrics

Track the following to validate the strategy:

- Total active opportunities displayed (target: 5,000+ within 90 days)
- Source diversity (no single source > 30% of listings)
- SME registration conversions (users who register on a source portal via TenderPath guidance)
- First-time bidder rate (% of users submitting their first-ever bid through a TenderPath-discovered opportunity)
- Data freshness (median time between opportunity publication and appearance on TenderPath, target: < 4 hours for Tier 1)
- Deduplication accuracy (< 2% duplicate listings displayed)

*This document should be treated as a living roadmap. As crawlers are deployed and data quality is assessed, the team should iterate on source priority, schema fields, and filtering logic based on what actually delivers value to SME users.*